

Smart Covers for the iPad 2

Apple's new smart cover protects the iPad 2, gives it first mover advantage for accessories, and no one dares cry foul

Phoenix 40-A

A mini UAV Phoenix 40 A works on six rotors and can detect motion and breathing when searching for hidden people

Acer Liquid Metal

Another Liquid that doesn't quite flow right

The build quality of the Acer Liquid Metal is very good, and the combination of plastic and stainless steel works well to give it a classy look.

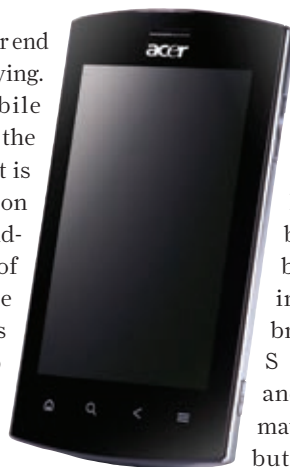
The Android 2.2 OS is skinned with Acer's custom Breeze UI. The phone is powered by an 800MHz Scorpion processor, which runs out of power if multiple apps are opened. The on-screen keyboard is a bit of a pain to use in portrait mode.

The call quality is quite good, and the earpiece does well when it comes to audio volume and clarity. Even in a noisy environment, there was no problem hearing what the

person on the other end of the line was saying.

Dolby Mobile sound enhances the audio quality, but is more enjoyable on a good set of headphones instead of the speaker. The 5MP camera does a pretty good job recording videos at 720p HD resolutions, with no motion blur or jerky frames. Pretty good for a camera phone, we must say.

Battery life has never been Android's strong point, but the Liquid Metal lasts over a day under normal usage conditions.



The Liquid Metal will appeal to those who want some fashion and like the Breeze UI. More discerning buyers will find better options in the same price bracket. The Galaxy S (S-LCD version) and the HTC Desire may be older phones, but they'll give the Liquid Metal a run for its money. Other smartphones in the same price range that are outside the Android ecosystem that you could consider are the Samsung Wave-II and the Nokia C7.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Quad Band GSM networks; 3G capable; 4G capable; 800MHz Scorpion processor; 3.6 inch display; 480x800 pixels; 5MP camera; 720p HD video recording; MicroSD up to 32GB; Wi-Fi/Bluetooth; Android 2.2 preinstalled; Breeze UI; 1500mAh battery

Contact

Acer India

Phone: 1800 116 677

Web site: www.acer.co.in

Price: ₹20,990

6.5
10

Features.....	6.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	8.0
Value for money.....	7.0

Specifications

Quad-band GSM smartphone; 3G capable; 1GHz processor; 2 GB memory (expandable to 32 GB); 3.7-inch touchscreen; Super Clear LCD type; 480x800 pixels resolution; 5 megapixel camera; bada OS 1.2; Touchwiz UI; 1500mAh battery

Contact

Samsung India

Phone: 1800 3000 8282, 18002668282

Web site: <http://www.in.samsung.com>

Price: ₹20,000

7.0
10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	8.0
Value for money.....	7.0

Samsung S8530 Wave-II

A bigger and better Wave

Out of the box, the Wave II looks exactly like its predecessor. The screen is slightly bigger (3.7 inches now vs. 3.3 inches on the Wave), but the buttons and menus are almost identical. The phone is solidly built, and its slim body sits comfortably in your hand.

The richness of the S-LCD display and amazing black levels are unbeatable, even by AMOLED screens. The touchscreen works brilliantly.



The bada 1.2 update feels more polished now, and has Samsung's TouchWiz user interface. Call quality is absolutely superb, and most ambient disturbances are well filtered out. Battery life is miles ahead of Android-based smartphones. The 1500 mAh battery lasted us for 2 days of normal use. The 5MP camera is extremely good when it comes to taking shots during the day, or in brightly lit conditions. In low light conditions pixellation starts to

show up. The 720p HD video recording is very smooth, even though we would have liked a bit more colour depth – colours seem a bit washed out.

For close to ₹20,000 (MRP), the Wave II feels like a costlier device, with a great touch experience and a very good display. However, in an increasingly competitive segment, with the likes of Samsung's own S-LCD Galaxy S and the Nokia C7, the Wave-II definitely has a tougher fight on its hands than its predecessor. The fact that bada is yet to garner love from app-developers doesn't help either.

Visbal Mathur